

PRIMARY EDUCATION

VARIABLES: Literacy rate, proportion of 10-plus children having completed primary education, ratio of girls to boys enrolled in primary and middle school, teacher-pupil ratio, total expenditure of education department on primary plus middle school/population within the age group 6-14 years

BIG STATES

RANK 2007		2007	2006	2005	2004	2003
1	KERALA	4.19	2	2	1	2
2	HIMACHAL PRADESH	4.09	1	1	2	1
3	UTTARAKHAND	3.70	3	3	5	NA
4	MAHARASHTRA	3.17	5	5	4	4
5	ASSAM	3.11	8	6	10	8
6	TAMIL NADU	2.98	4	4	3	3
7	PUNJAB	2.91	6	7	6	5
8	JAMMU & KASHMIR	2.89	10	8	7	7
9	KARNATAKA	2.77	7	9	8	6
10	GUJARAT	2.45	13	12	11	9
11	HARYANA	2.34	11	13	9	10
12	ANDHRA PRADESH	2.29	9	11	18	11
13	WEST BENGAL	2.27	12	14	12	12
14	CHHATTISGARH	1.84	15	17	15	NA
15	ORISSA	1.81	14	10	13	13
16	MADHYA PRADESH	1.72	16	15	14	14
17	RAJASTHAN	1.67	17	16	16	15
18	UTTAR PRADESH	1.35	18	19	17	16
19	JHARKHAND	1.27	19	18	18	NA
20	BIHAR	0.72	20	20	20	17

SMALL STATES

1	MIZORAM	6.20	2	2	2	NA
2	GOA	6.03	1	3	3	1
3	SIKKIM	5.37	4	1	1	NA
4	PUDUCHERRY	4.96	3	4	4	NA
5	NAGALAND	4.19	6	5	6	NA
6	MANIPUR	4.09	5	6	5	NA
7	DELHI	3.73	8	9	7	2
8	MEGHALAYA	3.49	9	8	9	NA
9	TRIPURA	3.48	7	7	8	NA
10	ARUNACHAL PRADESH	2.90	10	10	10	NA

UNION TERRITORIES

1	CHANDIGARH	4.66	3	3	3	NA
2	ANDAMAN & NICOBAR ISLANDS	4.27	1	2	2	NA
3	LAKSHADWEEP	4.06	2	1	1	NA
4	DAMAN & DIU	3.12	5	4	4	NA
5	DADRA & NAGAR HAVELI	2.83	4	5	5	NA

Uttar Pradesh is the FASTEST MOVER

Fastest Mover is the state where the rate of improvement on overall performance between 2003 and 2007 was greater than the rate of improvement between 1991 and 2003

what could be possible if the ruling regimes keep up the good work. Take the case of Tamil Nadu. Despite a volatile political atmosphere and virtually no line of communication, the political leaders have managed to fuel growth. The state has emerged as the fastest mover in investment, of which there is evidence in plenty, and also as the fastest growing consumer market. Of course, having a large contingent of Cabinet ministers from the state has helped, but it has worked hard to attract investments by investing in social and physical infrastructure. And that shows in its improved scores on four parameters, which places it fourth in the overall ranking. Arguably, if the health and education scores had not dropped, the state could have been in the top three.

The big story, though, is that the most populous states continue to languish at the bottom half of the rankings. Our study is now five years old and this year it affords a glimpse of five years of performance. Sadly, there is no new challenger for even the top 10 positions. Across the five-year period there has been no paradigm change in the rankings. Neither among the big states or the small states is there any shift in accent or emphasis. In the overall rankings, the winning quartet continues to be Punjab, Kerala, Himachal Pradesh and Tamil Nadu while among the small states it is the trio of Delhi, Puducherry and Goa. The laggards not only continue to lag but also show no improvement in scores. If consumer markets, investment and infrastructure were to be combined to deliver an index of industrial and economic development you would find Uttar Pradesh, Bihar, Jharkhand and West Bengal validating the theory of the dark continent east of Kanpur.

West Bengal, where the comrades have been in power for three decades, can boast of the most stable political climate amongst all the states. The state is also in the bottom half of the table on almost all parameters barring agriculture where it scores, thanks to land reforms and the acci-

UTTAR PRADESH HAS IMPROVED THE MOST IN PRIMARY EDUCATION. MIZORAM HAS EMERGED FROM BEHIND AS THE BEST AMONG SMALL STATES IN THE CATEGORY.

